

Research Paper

Overall, your research paper length should be:

Graduate students: 8-10 pages of content in your Intro, Body sections and Conclusion

Undergraduate students: 4-5 pages of content in your Intro, Body sections and Conclusion

The paper must be in APA v.7 format and should be double spaced on standard sized 8.5"x11" page size with 1" margins on all sides with 12pt Times New Roman font. You will need a title page, abstract page, the paper itself, and a references page.

Please format your title page and abstract page according to these instructions:

https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/research_and_citation/apa_style/apa_formatting_and_style_guide/general_format.htmlLinks to an external site.

Note: The page counts above only include the content of the paper itself and does not include the title, abstract, or references pages.

The Purdue OWL site can also help you with in-text citations, your paper in general, and your reference list (which should be similar to your bibliography but only includes works that you cited in your paper from a paraphrase or direct quote). Please review the entire guide and the sample paper which can be found here:

https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/research_and_citation/apa_style/apa_formatting_and_style_guide/apa_sample_paper.htmlLinks to an external site.

Also, you are welcome to use section headings in your paper, but if you do, I would recommend not going past the top 1 or 2 levels. Your paper should flow from one issue to the next regardless of if headings are used. Don't try to use section headings as a substitute for the flow and cohesiveness of your paper. Example: Let's say that you want to go from a body section about A to a section about B. You would need to end the A section with a sentence or two of lead in to the B section which will tie the two sections together. I don't want you to simply end the A section, put a section header on the B topic, and then start up on the B topic with no sort of tie in leading from the one section to the next.

Please do not include a section heading for your introduction--per APA standards. If you use section headings, make sure you follow these rules:

https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/research_and_citation/apa_style/apa_formatting_and_style_guide/apa_headings_and_seriation.htmlLinks to an external site.

Pay particular attention to the APA headings information in the above link which shows how the different levels of your headings should be formatted:

Use of direct quotes should be limited within your paper and no more than fifteen percent of material included in any paper may be direct quotes. Wikipedia and other online wikis may not be used as a reference or cited. Please do not use unreliable websites, blogs, or general news articles as sources. Submission of the papers with great effort for actual publication is highly encouraged and I am happy to help with that.

Be particularly careful not to plagiarize which means that any information that you learned from a resource and didn't not have existing first hand knowledge of needs to be cited. Direct quotes and paraphrasing both must be cited.

Lastly, please make sure you have a proper thesis statement which you paper should revolve around. Your thesis statement should appear at the end of your introduction. Please check out this site for help with your thesis:

https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/general_writing/academic_writing/establishing_arguments/index.htmlLinks to an external site.

I highly recommend you review the rubric to see exactly what I am looking for and how this paper will be graded.

Submit as a doc or docx.

The research paper is due **before class** time on 4/6. (Your assignments have typically been due before midnight, but I don't want students to be working on their research paper during class.) Once you review any provided feedback on your graded outlines that have already been posted, you may start on the research paper.

.

Research Paper Rubric

Research Paper Rubric

Criteria	Ratings
Paper Formatting	Outstanding work reflecting substantial effort No errors or issues regarding APA format. Please review the instructions as well as the Purdue OWL guide to ensure all parts of your paper follow APA v.7 format. This grading section does not include references page or in-text citations issues. The paper should be 8-10 pages (Grad) or 4-5 pages (Undergrad) of content and the page count should not include the title, abstract, and references pages. A paper with less than the minimum specified number of pages of content will not be accepted. 15 pts Adequate work 1-2 errors or issues 12 pts Marginally satisfactory work 3-4 errors or issues 9 pts Unsatisfactory work 5+ errors or issues 4.5 pts

References Page and In- text Citations	Outstanding work reflecting substantial effort No errors or issues with your references page and in-text citations (which must be in APA v.7 format). Keep in mind that "errors or issues" pertain to formatting problems. If you fail to cite a source in your paper, you will receive a zero on this paper and an F will be filed for plagiarism. BE VERY CAREFUL AND DOUBLE CHECK YOUR PAPER TO ENSURE THAT YOU HAVE IN-TEXT CITATIONS FOR ALL DIRECT QUOTES AND PARAPHRASING. See the syllabus for additional details regarding plagiarism. 15 pts Adequate work 1-2 errors or issues 12 pts Marginally satisfactory work 3-4 errors or issues 9 pts Unsatisfactory work 5+ errors or issues. You will also lose one additional letter grade on the paper if you are completely missing the references page or didn't make any effort to put the references page in APA format. 4.5 pts
---	---

Sources	Outstanding work reflecting substantial effort At least 8 sources in your references page. Online wikis, unreliable websites, blogs, or general news articles were not be used as a reference or cited. 15 pts Unsatisfactory work Less than 8 sources appear in your references page or if any of your sources are from online wikis, unreliable websites, blogs, or general news articles. 0 pts
Integration of Knowledge	Outstanding work reflecting substantial effort The paper demonstrates that the author fully understands and has applied concepts learned in the course. Concepts are integrated into the writer's own insights. The writer provides concluding remarks that show analysis and synthesis of ideas. 20 pts Adequate work The paper demonstrates that the author, for the most part, understands and has applied concepts learned in the course. Some of the conclusions, however, are not supported in the body of the paper. 16 pts Marginally satisfactory work The paper demonstrates that the author, to a certain extent, understands and has applied concepts learned in the course. 12 pts

	Unsatisfactory work The paper does not demonstrate that the author has understood and applied concepts learned in the course. 0 pts
Topic Focus	Outstanding work reflecting substantial effort The topic is focused narrowly enough for the scope of this assignment. A thesis statement is included at the end of the introduction that provides direction for the paper, either by statement of a position or hypothesis. 20 pts Adequate work The topic is focused but lacks direction. The paper is about a specific topic but the writer has not established a position or hypothesis with their thesis statement. 16 pts Marginally satisfactory work

	The topic is too broad for the scope of this assignment and is missing a thesis statement at the end of the introduction. 12 pts Unsatisfactory work The topic is not clearly defined and is missing a thesis statement at the end of the introduction. 6 pts
Depth of Discussion	Outstanding work reflecting substantial effort In-depth discussion & elaboration in all sections of the paper. Used limited direct quotes. 25 pts Adequate work In-depth discussion & elaboration in most sections of the paper. Used direct quotes in less than 15% of material in the paper. 20 pts Marginally satisfactory work The writer has omitted pertinent content or content runs-on excessively. Quotations from others outweigh the writer's own content or content runs-on excessively. Used direct quotes in less than 15% of material in the paper. 15 pts

	Unsatisfactory work Cursory discussion in all the sections of the paper or brief discussion in only a few sections and/or used direct quotes in more than 15% of material in the paper. 0 pts
Paragraphs	Outstanding work reflecting substantial effort Ideas broken up into paragraphs properly with generally only 3-5 sentences per paragraph. 10 pts Adequate work Paper contained more than 3 run on paragraphs that contained more than 5 sentences maximum. 8 pts Marginally satisfactory work Paper contained more than 5 run on paragraphs that contained more than 5 sentences maximum. 6 pts Unsatisfactory work

	Paper contained more than 8 run on paragraphs that contained more than 5 sentences maximum. 0 pts
Cohesiveness	Outstanding work reflecting substantial effort Ties together information from all sources. Paper flows from one issue to the next regardless of headings used. (You didn't t use headings as a substitute for paragraph flow.) Author's writing demonstrates an understanding of the relationship among material obtained from all sources. 20 pts Adequate work For the most part, ties together information from all sources. Paper flows with only some disjointedness. Author's writing demonstrates an understanding of the relationship among material obtained from all sources. 16 pts Marginally satisfactory work Sometimes ties together information from all sources. Paper does not flow - disjointedness is apparent. Author's writing do demonstrate an understanding of the relationship among material obtained from all sources. 12 pts

	Unsatisfactory work Does not tie together information. Paper does not flow and appears to be created from disparate issues. Headings are the only things linking concepts. Writing does not demonstrate understanding any relationships. 6 pts
Spelling and Grammar	Outstanding work reflecting substantial effort No spelling or grammar issues. (Grammar issues include, but are not limited to, run-on sentences and incomplete sentences) 10 pts Adequate work 1-5 spelling or grammar issues. 8 pts Marginally satisfactory work

	5-10 spelling or grammar issues. 6 pts Unsatisfactory work 10+ spelling or grammar issues. 0 pts
--	--